



PHOTO BY BANDEEP SINGH

1. & 2. Cricketer Yuvraj Singh has entered the tequila market with FINO. The tequila is available in four variants—Blanco, Rosado, Reposado and, Añejo. Blanco is priced at ₹13,889, Rosado at ₹34,038, while Reposado retails at ₹19,175 and Añejo at ₹30,478

3. & 4. In 2025, actor Ranveer Singh co-founded RANGEELA Vodka in partnership with ABD Maestro; priced at ₹2,400 for 750ML

brand, which is also associated with Shah Rukh Khan, has framed itself as a luxury lifestyle proposition spanning fashion and fine spirits. Alcobev major Radico Khaitan and Zerodha Co founder Nikhil Kamath have joined hands to launch a premium tequila under D'YAVOL Spirits.

Late last year, actor Ranveer Singh co-founded RANGEELA Vodka in partnership with ABD Maestro, a subsidiary of Allied Blenders and Distillers Ltd. The triple distilled and platinum chill-filtered vodka is marketed as bold, vibrant, and 'filmy', aimed at young, trendsetting consumers. RANGEELA has debuted in Maharashtra at a price of ₹2,400 for 750ML, with Goa, West Bengal, and markets of North India to follow in quick succession.

Vikram Achanta, Founder and CEO of alco-bev training company Tulleeho and co-founder of 30 Best Bars India, views the movement with a seasoned eye. "In India, celebrity-backed alcohol brands get a

massive head start. A famous face provides instant trust and a ready-made personality that traditional brands invest a lot in to build. It's a shortcut to that crucial first trial." However, he cautions that momentum isn't the same as loyalty. While curiosity sells the first bottle, once the novelty fades, consumers judge the product on the same merits as any other: taste, price, and consistency. Shalini Sharma, Head of Marketing, Piccadilly Distilleries, which owns brands such as Indri and Camikara, agrees. "Our decision to bypass the face-led model stems from a deep-rooted belief in a 'product-first' philosophy. While a famous face can drive a trial purchase, only the quality of the spirit can drive long-term loyalty."

Achanta has the final word: "A celebrity can open the door, but they can't keep people in the room if the product doesn't deliver." **BT**

@smitabw